

Solutions & Portfolios

portfolio

User Manual

Aggregated flow reports across multiple ARTs, solutions and portfolios

1. What is 'Solutions & Portfolios'?

Until now SituationReport always looked at one team group or ART. The Solutions & Portfolios module (technically: `portfolio`) combines several already-configured ARTs into one shared report — at Large-Solution or portfolio level.

You configure each ART once as usual (in `build_reports`, as a project template). After that you only state which ARTs belong to a solution — and get an aggregated report across all of them.

In short: a solution = several ARTs combined. A portfolio = several solutions combined. The ART reports themselves do not change; they are only referenced.

2. Key concepts

Term	Meaning
ART	Agile Release Train / team group — the level you already analyse today in <code>build_reports</code> .
Solution	A grouping of several ARTs. Refers to their project templates.
Portfolio	A grouping of several solutions (nested: portfolio > solutions > ARTs).
Template	A saved configuration. ARTs are included via their <code>build_reports</code> template; a solution can itself be saved as a template and referenced by a portfolio.
Pooled	Mode: all issues are merged into one dataset — the solution seen as a single system.
Comparison	Mode: each unit (ART or solution) is shown separately, side by side.

3. Starting

3.1 From the launcher

Start SituationReport. The entry screen is split: left 'Large Solutions & Portfolios', right the familiar ART tools. Click the Solutions & Portfolios card on the left.

3.2 Directly

Alternatively, without the launcher:

```
python -m portfolio
```

Without arguments the graphical interface opens. With arguments the command-line interface runs (see section 6).

4. The interface step by step

Field / action	Description
Name	Name of the solution or portfolio (shown in the report).
Terminology	SAFe or Global — labelling of the report metrics.
Kind	solution (members are ARTs) or portfolio (members are solutions).
From / To	Optional reporting period (YYYY-MM-DD).
Add ART	One row per member: name + source. For 'solution' the source is an ART template (.json) or an IssueTimes.xlsx directly; for 'portfolio' a solution template (.json).
Browse	Pick the source file.
Report mode	Pooled or Comparison (see section 5).
Save	Save the configuration as JSON (= a reusable template).
Load	Open a saved configuration.
Generate report	Build the report. Extension .html = web page, .pdf = PDF. It opens afterwards.

Tip: a saved solution file is your solution template. To build a portfolio, choose Kind = portfolio and point each member at such a saved solution file.

5. The report

5.1 Management summary

At the very top sits a compact figures table — one row per unit (in pooled mode a single row for the whole solution/portfolio):

Figure	Meaning
Items	Number of issues in the period.
Completed	Of those, the closed ones.
Open (WIP)	Open issues (still in progress).
Median / 85th / 95th CT	Cycle time in days — median plus 85th and 95th percentile.
<= Nd	Share of completed issues within the target (Target CT, default 90 days).

5.2 Pooled vs. comparison

Pooled answers: How is the solution doing as a whole? All issues are merged and analysed together.

Comparison answers: Which unit is the outlier? For a solution each ART is shown separately, for a portfolio each solution. Charts are placed side by side per metric.

5.3 The metrics

Metric	What it shows
Flow Velocity	Throughput: completed items per period/PI.
Flow Time	Cycle-time distribution (boxplot, scatter with trend).
Flow Distribution	Split by issue type and stage shares.
CFD	Cumulative Flow Diagram (see 5.4).
Flow Load	Aging WIP — comparison mode per ART only, as it is workflow-dependent.

5.4 CFD across different workflows

Different ARTs often use different workflow stages. To make a shared CFD possible, the module automatically maps every stage to one of three canonical groups — To Do, In Progress, Done — and sums the counts per group. This keeps the CFD comparable across ARTs with different workflows.

6. Command line (CLI)

For automation and reproducible reports:

```
python -m portfolio my_solution.json --output report.html
```

```
python -m portfolio my_solution.json --mode comparison --pdf report.pdf
```

Option	Meaning
<config>	Path to the solution/portfolio configuration (JSON).
--output FILE	Write the HTML report to this file.
--pdf FILE	Write a multi-page PDF report.
--mode pooled comparison	Aggregation mode (default: pooled).
--metrics ID ...	Specific metrics (default depends on the mode).
--terminology SAFe Global	Labelling mode (default: SAFe).
--target-ct DAYS	Target cycle time in days (default: 90).
--browser	Open the generated HTML report in the browser.

7. Frequently asked questions (FAQ)

Do I have to reconfigure the ARTs?

No. The module references the existing ART templates. Each ART template remains the single source of truth.

Why is 'Flow Load' missing from the pooled report?

Flow Load groups by current stage. Across different workflows that is not comparable, so it appears only in comparison mode per ART.

Why is the target-CT share low or shown as a dash?

A dash means there are no completed issues with a valid cycle time in the period. A low percentage means many issues take longer than the target.

How do I create a portfolio?

First save each solution. Then create a new configuration with Kind = portfolio and point each member at a saved solution file.

8. Glossary

Term	Explanation
ART	Agile Release Train — multi-team structure in SAFe.
CFD	Cumulative Flow Diagram — cumulative issue count per stage.
Cycle Time	Time from the first active stage to completion.
PI	Program Increment — fixed planning period (often 8 to 12 weeks).
Pooling	Merging several datasets at the issue level.
WIP	Work in Progress — open, not-yet-completed issues.